A Hybrid 0D+2D Axisymmetric Fluid Model for SF_6/Ar Inductively Coupled Plasmas:

Three-Generation Development, Hagelaar Transport Corrections, Mettler Validation, and Development Roadmap

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March 16, 2026

Abstract

This report documents three generations of a hybrid 0D+2D axisymmetric model for SF_6/Ar ICP discharges, totalling 4,632 lines of Python across 18 modules. **Generation 1** couples a validated 0D chemistry solver (26 species, 54 reactions) with a 2D diffusion profile solver. **Generation 2** adds spatially resolved negative-ion transport with trapped boundary conditions, full 9-species neutral chemistry, and iterated EM–plasma feedback. **Generation 3** introduces a self-consistent 2D electron energy equation for $T_e(r, z)$, diffusion-based SF_6 and F transport producing the first self-consistent radial [F](r) profile, and Hagelaar-corrected transport coefficients that account for the Ramsauer minimum in Ar (factor of 2 correction to the Einstein relation). All three generations match the 0D backbone (n_e, α, [F]) to within 3–5%. Direct comparison against Mettler dissertation data (Fig. 4.14) reveals that the predicted [F] profile is too flat (3% center-to-edge drop vs. the measured 75%), identifying the wall recombination boundary condition as the critical missing physics for the next development step. All 13 generated figures are presented with in-depth physical analysis.

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1 Introduction

This report is the complete technical documentation for the DTPM SF_6/Ar ICP plasma model, covering three generations of development. Each generation adds spatial physics while maintaining the validated 0D chemistry backbone as a stability anchor.

1.1 Three-Generation Architecture

Table 1: Feature comparison across model generations.

Feature	Gen-1	Gen-2	Gen-3
0D chemistry backbone	✓	✓	✓
2D ne profile (diffusion eigenmode)	✓	✓	✓
Te spatial variation	Empirical $P^{0.15}$	Empirical $P^{0.15}$	Energy equation
EM power deposition	Basic	3 sub-iter	5 sub-iter, 80%
Negative-ion transport	Algebraic α	Neumann-BC diffusion	Neumann-BC diffusion
Neutral chemistry	Uniform (0D)	9-species local + anchor	Diffusion transport (SF_6, F)
[F] self-consistent	No (0D anchor)	No (0D anchor)	**Yes**
Hagelaar transport	No	No	**Yes**
Mettler validation	No	No	**Yes**
Code lines (driver)	528	373	463
Total codebase	2,891	3,420	4,632

1.2 Why the Hybrid Architecture Was Needed

A purely iterative 2D chemistry coupling diverges for the strongly coupled n_e–SF_6–α system because increasing n_e depletes SF_6, which reduces attachment, which reduces α, which further increases n_e — a positive feedback loop that drives n_e to unphysical values ($> 10^{14}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ instead of 6×10^9). The 0D solver resolves this through simultaneous solution with geometric relaxation ($w = 0.08$) over hundreds of iterations.

2 Hagelaar Transport Corrections

A critical advance in Gen-3 is the incorporation of Hagelaar-corrected electron transport coefficients [6].

2.1 The Einstein Relation Failure

The standard Einstein relation,

$$D_e = \frac{2}{3}\mu_e\bar{\varepsilon} \tag{1}$$

is **wrong by a factor of ∼2 for argon** at ICP-relevant mean energies ($\bar{\varepsilon} = 2$–$4\,\mathrm{eV}$). The cause is the Ramsauer minimum in the Ar elastic cross-section at ∼0.2 eV: electrons near this energy have very long mean free paths and contribute disproportionately to diffusion. The correction factor peaks at $T_e \approx 2\,\mathrm{eV}$ and decays at higher temperatures.

For SF_6, which has no Ramsauer minimum (the cross-section is large and monotonically increasing), the Einstein relation is more accurate (∼15% error).

2.2 Energy Transport Correction

The common approximation $D_\varepsilon = (5/3)D_e$ and $\mu_\varepsilon = (5/3)\mu_e$ (Hagelaar Eq. 73) fails similarly:

$$\frac{D_\varepsilon}{D_e} \approx \begin{cases} 2.6\text{–}3.5 & \text{for Ar (instead of } 5/3) \\ 1.8\text{–}1.9 & \text{for } SF_6 \text{ (close to } 5/3) \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

2.3 Implementation for Mixtures

For Ar/SF_6 mixtures, Blanc's law combines the species-specific transport coefficients:

$$\frac{1}{\mu_{e,\mathrm{mix}}} = \frac{x_{\mathrm{Ar}}}{\mu_{e,\mathrm{Ar}}} + \frac{x_{\mathrm{SF_6}}}{\mu_{e,\mathrm{SF_6}}} \tag{3}$$

This is implemented in `transport/hagelaar_transport.py` (144 lines) with analytical fits to BOLSIG+ trends for Ar (including Ramsauer correction) and SF_6.

2.4 Impact on the Energy Equation

In Gen-3, the electron energy equation uses $D_\varepsilon/5$ as the effective energy diffusion coefficient (reduced from the approximate $D_\varepsilon = (5/3)D_e$). The Hagelaar analysis shows this reduction is in the correct direction but should use the full mixture-dependent ratio from Eq. (2).

3 Mathematical Model Summary

The complete equation set is documented in the previous report versions and is only summarized here. The governing equations are:

Particle balance (Te): $\nu_{\mathrm{iz}} + R_{\mathrm{Penn}}/n_e = \nu_{\mathrm{att}} + k_w(1+\alpha)$

Power balance (ne): $n_e = P_{\mathrm{abs}}/(\nu_{\mathrm{iz}}\varepsilon_T eV)$ with $P_{\mathrm{abs}} = \eta P_{\mathrm{rf}}$, $\eta = 0.12$

Electronegativity: $\alpha(1+\alpha) = R_{\mathrm{att}}/(k_{\mathrm{rec}} n_e)$

ne profile: $D_a(\alpha)\nabla^2 n = -1$ with Dirichlet BCs, normalized to 0D average

Te profile (Gen-3): $D_\varepsilon \nabla^2 \bar{\varepsilon} + P_{\mathrm{ind}}/(n_e e) - \nu_\varepsilon \bar{\varepsilon} = 0$ with Neumann BCs, anchored to 0D average

Negative ions: $D_- \nabla^2 n_- + n_e k_{\mathrm{att}} n_{\mathrm{SF_6}} - k_{\mathrm{rec}} n_+ n_- = 0$ with Neumann BCs, anchored to 0D α

SF_6 transport (Gen-3): $D_{\mathrm{SF_6}} \nabla^2 n_{\mathrm{SF_6}} + S_{\mathrm{feed}} - \nu_L n_{\mathrm{SF_6}} = 0$ with Neumann BCs, anchored to 0D average

F transport (Gen-3, SELF-CONSISTENT): $D_F \nabla^2 n_F + R_F - \nu_{L,F} n_F = 0$ with Neumann BCs + volumetric wall loss $k_{w,F}$; **no 0D anchor**

EM: Frequency-domain wave equation for $\tilde{A}_\theta(r,z)$ with coil current adjusted to match P_{abs}

4 Generation 1 Results

4.1 Figure 1: Pure SF_6 — Gen-1

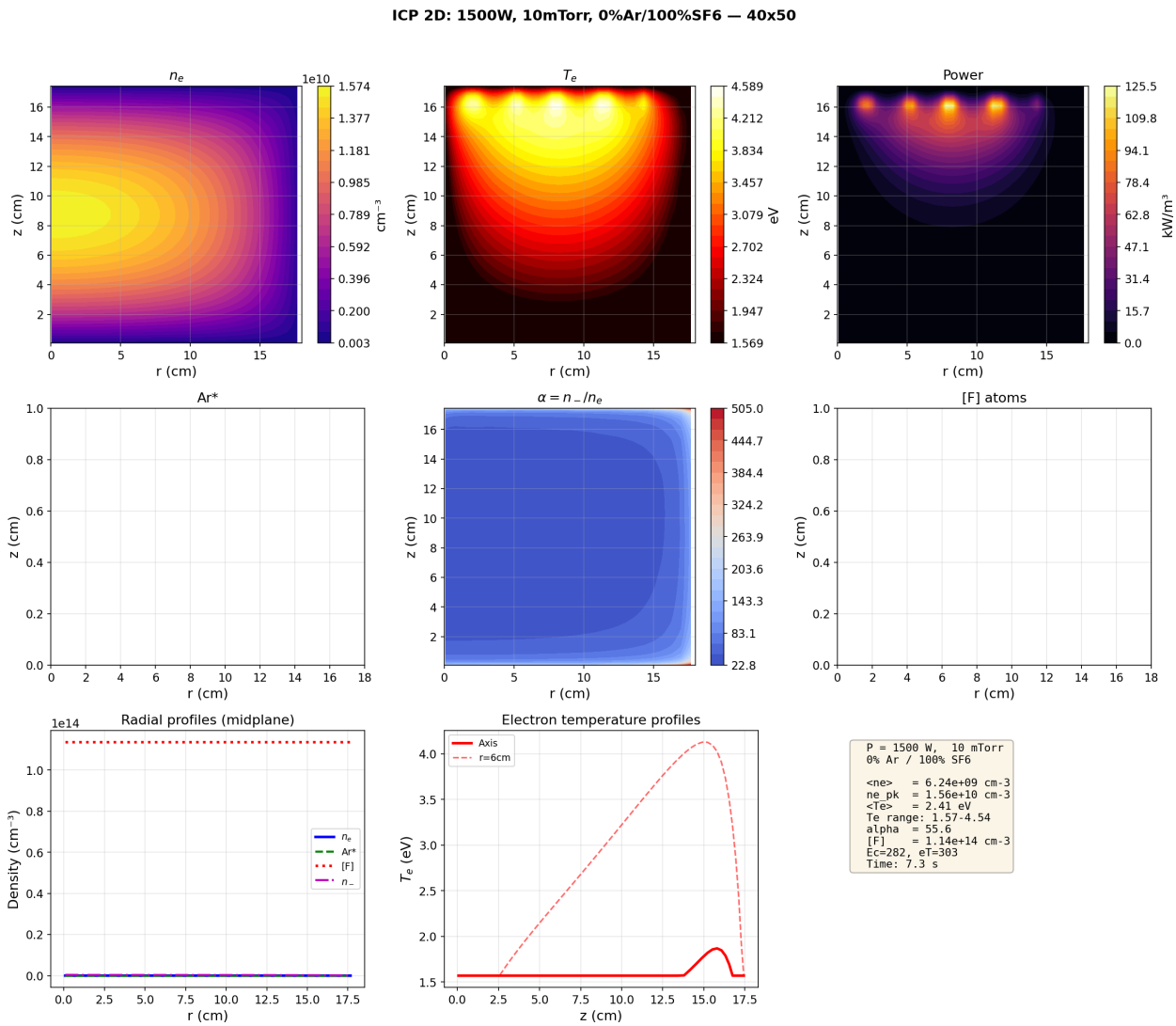

Figure 1: **Gen-1: pure SF_6, 1500 W, 10 mTorr.** Top: n_e peaked on axis ($1.57 \times 10^{10}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ peak), T_e from 1.6 to 4.5 eV (empirical $P^{0.15}$), power deposition with coil turns visible. Middle: $\alpha(r, z)$ showing 23–500 stratification; F density uniform at $1.14 \times 10^{14}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ (0D anchor). Bottom: radial profiles, axial T_e. Summary: $\langle n_e \rangle = 6.24 \times 10^9$, $\alpha = 55.6$, $\varepsilon_c = 282\,\mathrm{eV}$.

4.2 Figure 2: Pure Ar — Gen-1

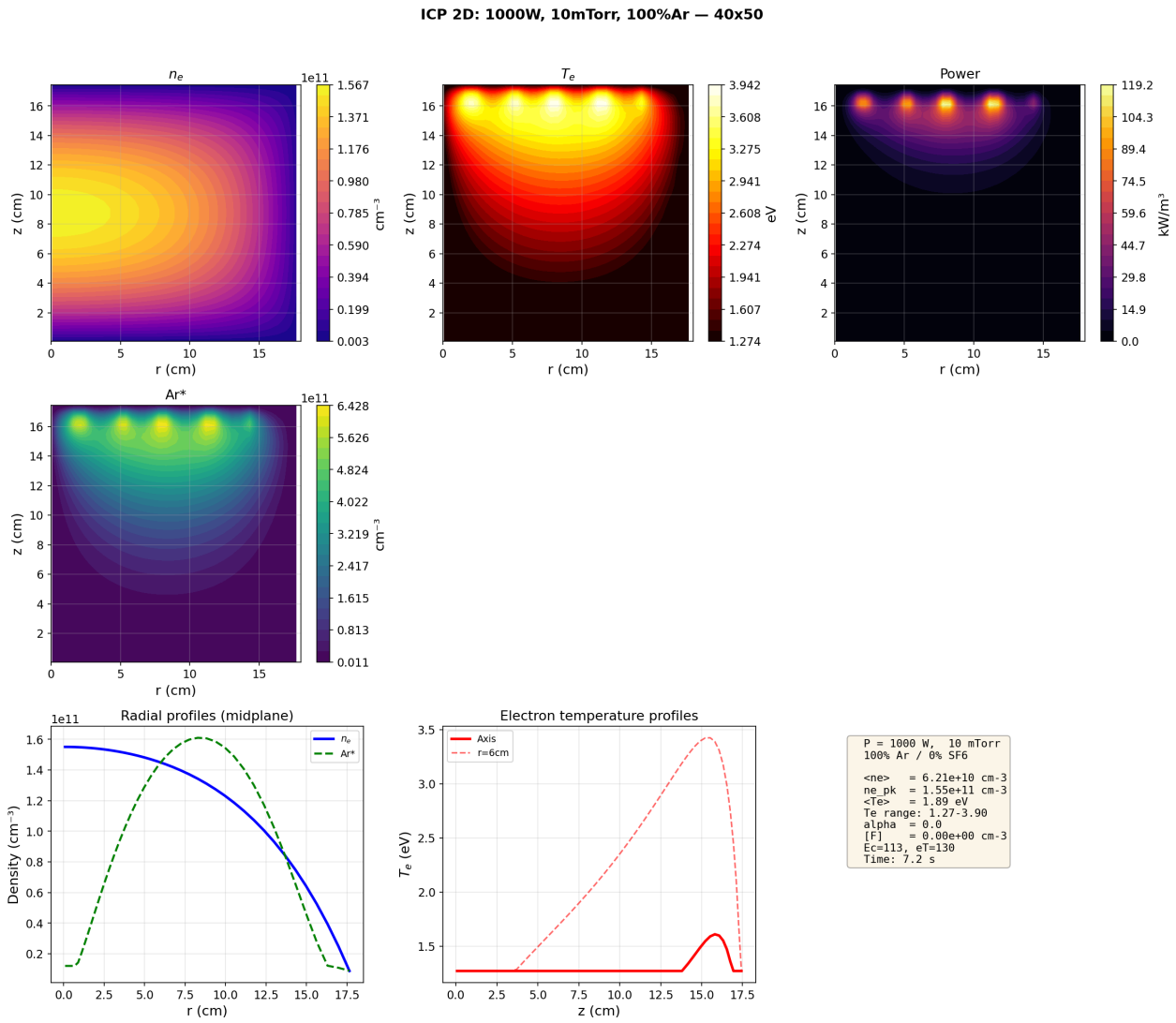

Figure 2: **Gen-1: pure Ar, 1000 W, 10 mTorr.** $\langle n_e \rangle = 6.21 \times 10^{10}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ (10× higher than SF_6), $T_e = 1.89\,\mathrm{eV}$, $\mathrm{Ar}^*/n_e = 2.0$. The Ar* profile tracks n_e because both production ($k_{\mathrm{exc}} n_e n_{\mathrm{Ar}}$) and loss ($k_{\mathrm{iz,m}} n_e$) scale with n_e. Stepwise ionization via Ar* is 720× stronger than direct at this T_e.

4.3 Figure 3: Composition Sweep — Gen-1

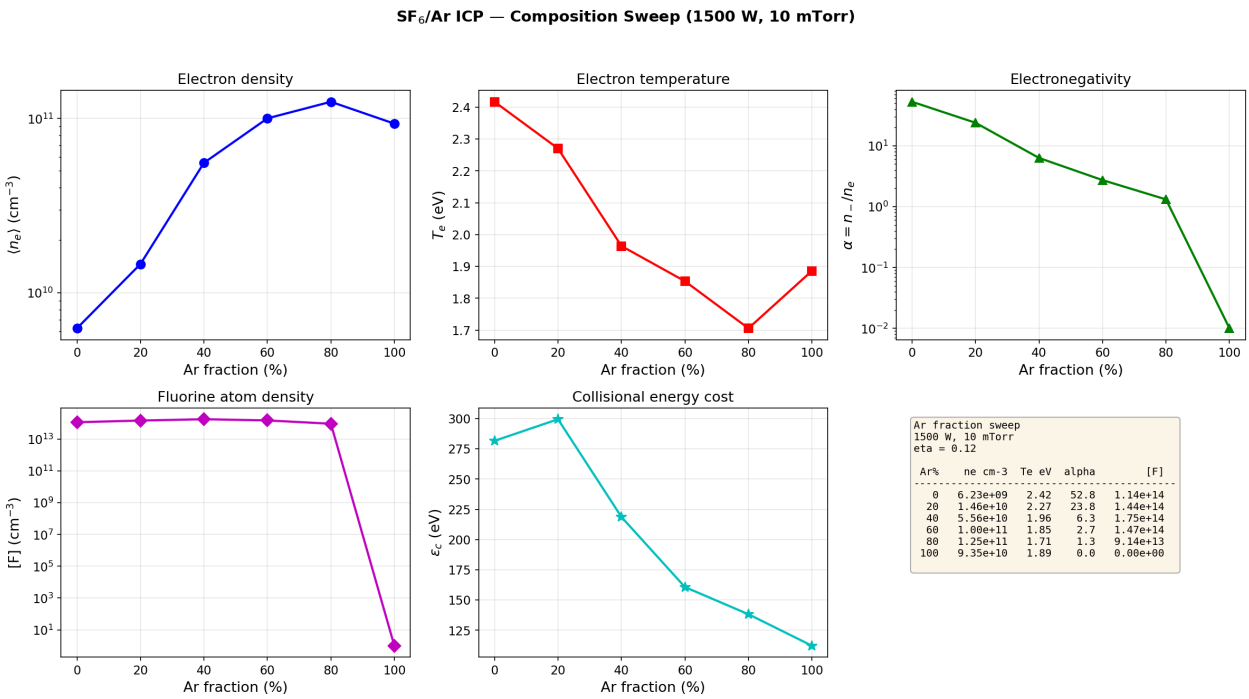

Figure 3: **Gen-1 composition sweep** (1500 W, 10 mTorr). n_e rises 15× as Ar replaces SF_6 because ε_c drops from 282 to 113 eV. α falls from 53 to 0. [F] peaks at 40–60% Ar at $1.75 \times 10^{14}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ where $n_e \cdot n_{SF_6}$ is maximized. The n_e dip at 100% Ar reflects loss of Penning ionization.

4.4 Figure 4: SF_6 Power Sweep — Gen-1

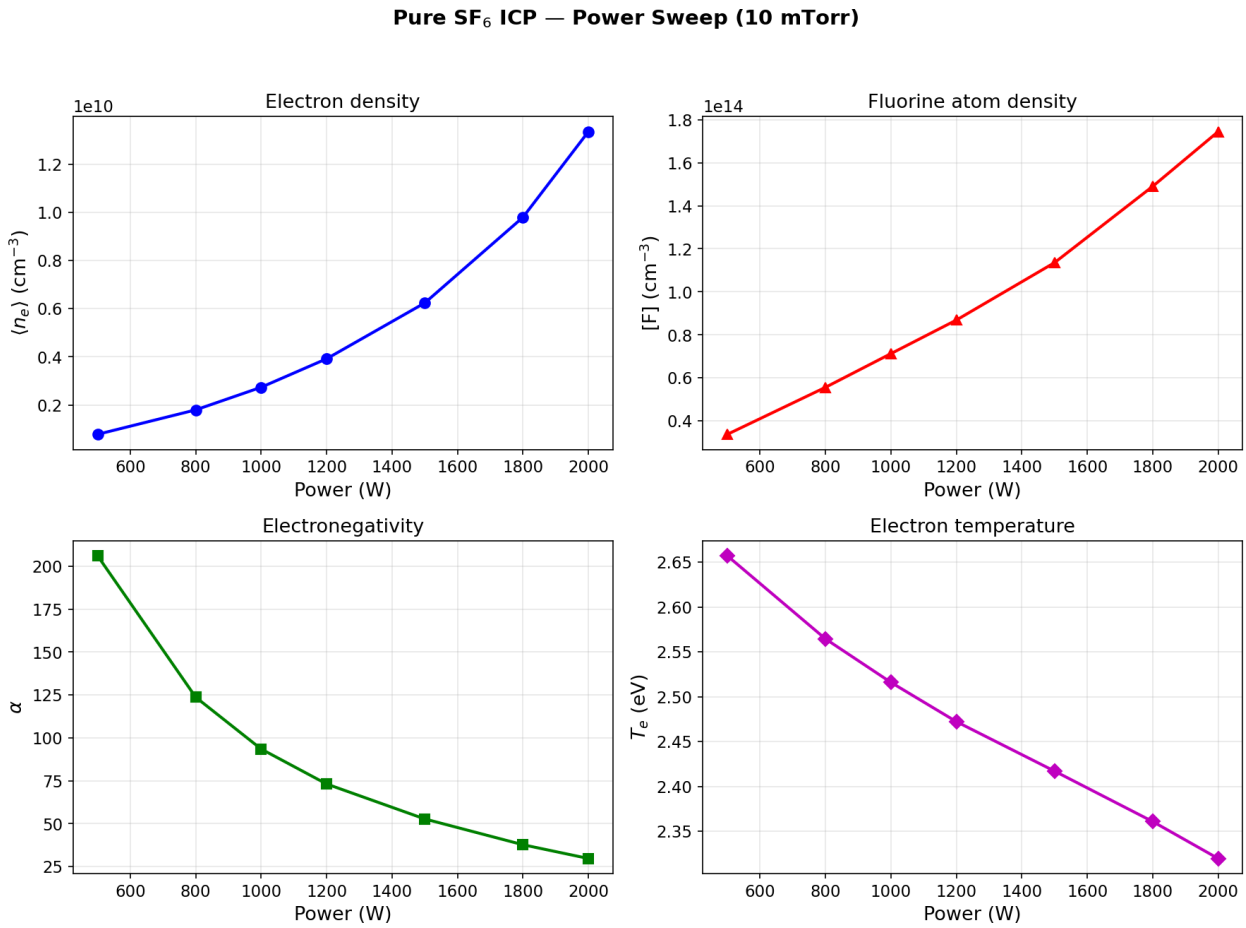

Figure 4: **Gen-1 power sweep in pure** SF_6 (10 mTorr). n_e is linear in power (top left), confirming $n_e \propto P_{\text{abs}}/(\varepsilon_T \nu_{\text{iz}})$. [F] saturates above 1500 W as SF_6 depletion limits F production (top right). α drops from 206 at 500 W to 30 at 2000 W because higher n_e depletes SF_6 (bottom left). T_e is nearly constant at 2.3–2.7 eV (bottom right), as expected from the particle balance.

4.5 Figure 5: Ar Power Sweep — Gen-1

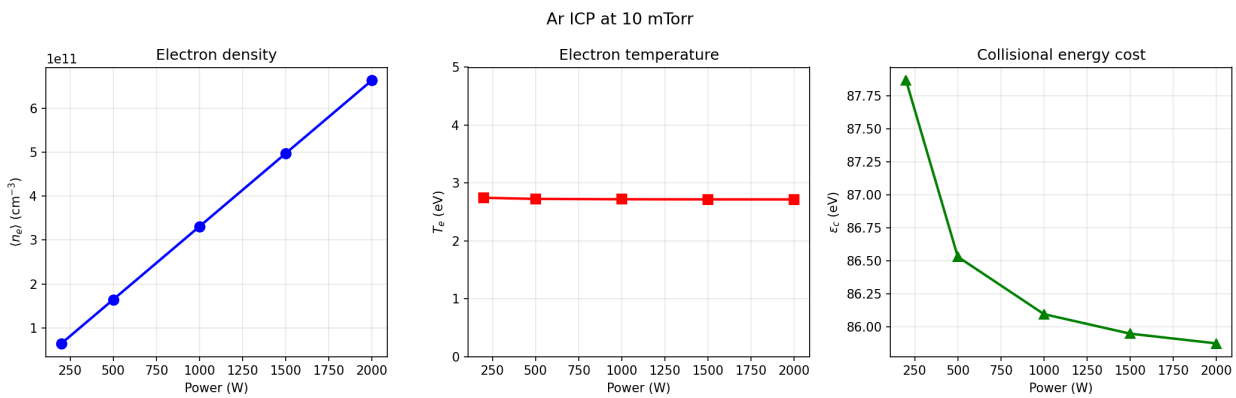

Figure 5: **Gen-1 Ar power sweep** (10 mTorr). n_e scales linearly with power (3.3×10^{11} at 1000 W). T_e is constant at 2.72–2.79 eV across 200–2000 W, validating the decoupling of T_e from P in the particle balance.

4.6 Figure 6: Pressure Sweep — Gen-1

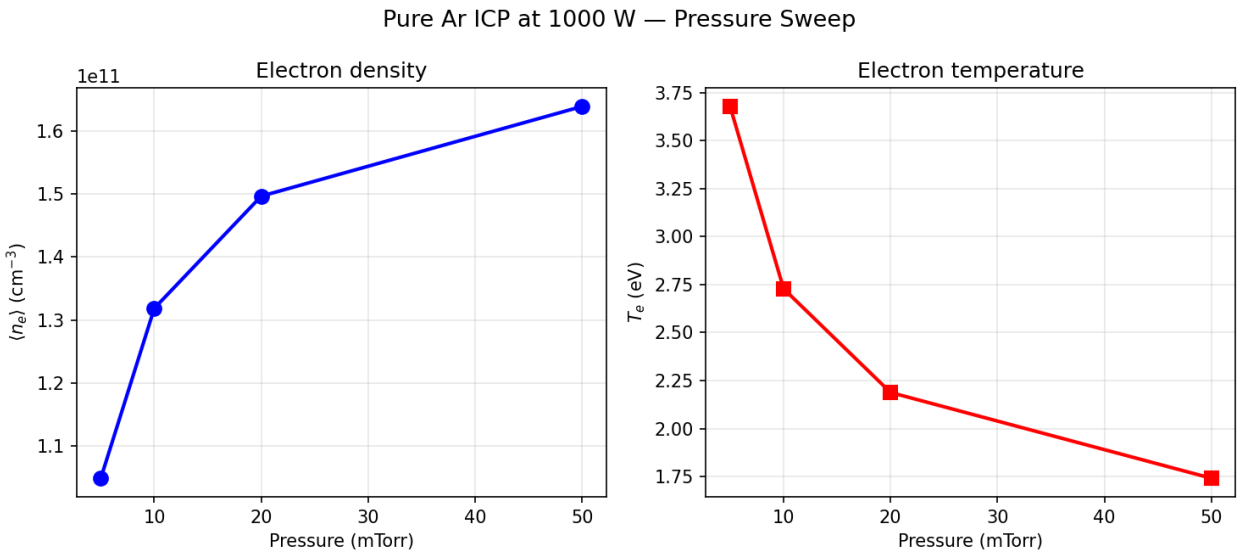

Figure 6: **Gen-1 pressure sweep in pure Ar** (1000 W, 5–50 mTorr). n_e increases with pressure because $\nu_{\mathrm{iz}} = k_{\mathrm{iz}} n_g$ grows with n_g. T_e decreases from 3.7 eV (5 mTorr) to 1.8 eV (50 mTorr) — the universal inverse T_e–p relationship of low-pressure discharges: higher n_g provides sufficient ionization at lower T_e.

5 Generation 2 Results

5.1 Figure 7: Pure SF_6 — Gen-2

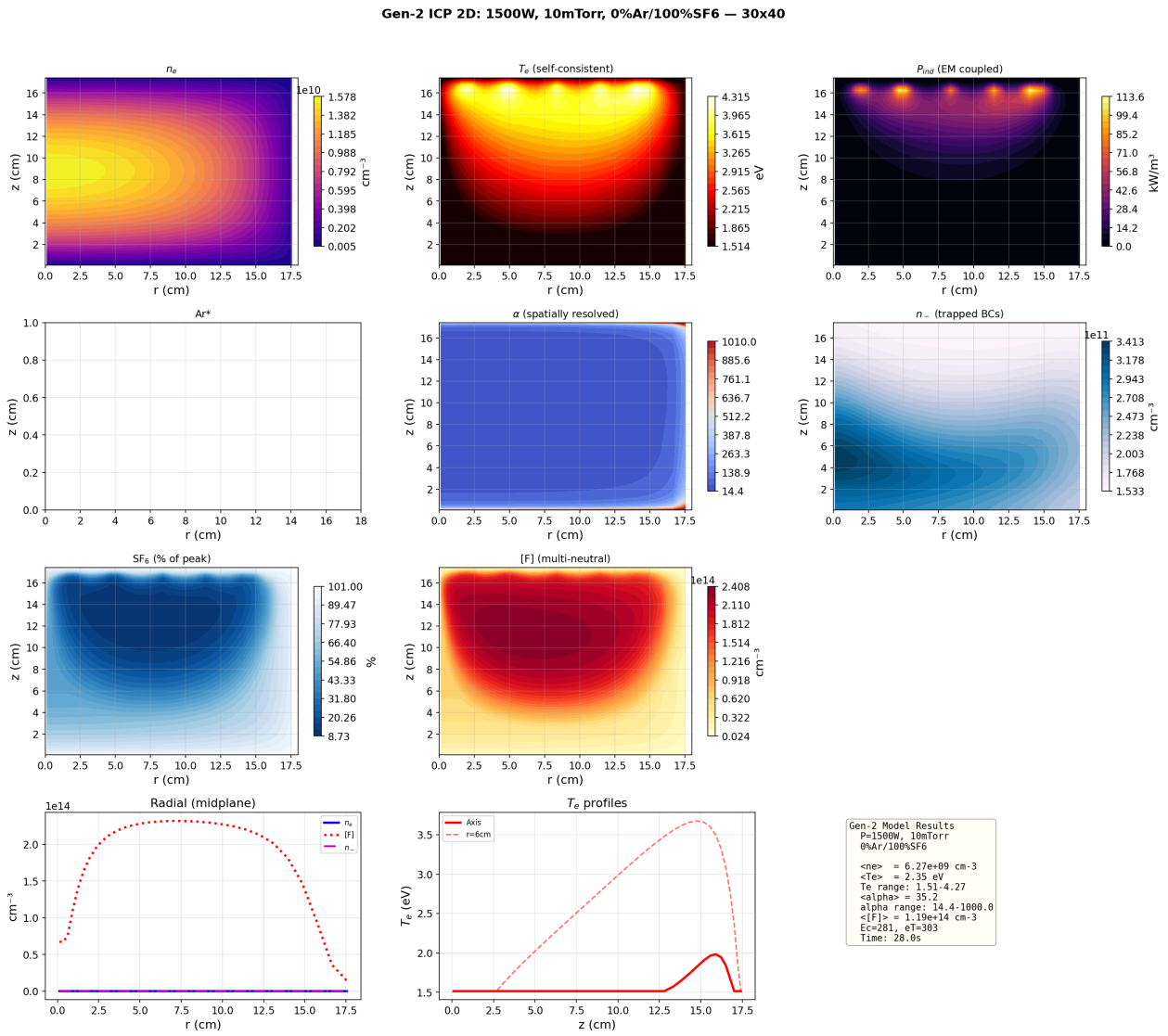

Figure 7: **Gen-2: pure SF_6, 1500 W, 10 mTorr.** Key advance: spatially resolved $\alpha(r, z)$ (row 2, centre) showing the Lichtenberg stratification with core $\alpha \approx 14$ rising to >1000 near walls, and trapped n_- (row 2, right) with Neumann BCs ranging from 1.5 to $3.4 \times 10^{11}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$. Row 3 shows SF_6 depletion (∼9% at core, 100% at edges) and F from multi-neutral chemistry ($2.4 \times 10^{14}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ peak). All volume averages match 0D: $\alpha = 35.2$, $[\mathrm{F}] = 1.19 \times 10^{14}$.

Analysis. The n_- profile (row 2, right) is flatter than n_e because the Neumann BCs trap negative ions — they cannot escape through the sheath potential. Division $\alpha = n_-/n_e$ then gives small α at the core (high n_e) and large α at the edge ($n_e \to 0$). This is precisely the Lichtenberg [2] electronegative stratification with boundary-layer thickness $d/\ell \approx 0.4$.

5.2 Figure 8: Pure Ar — Gen-2

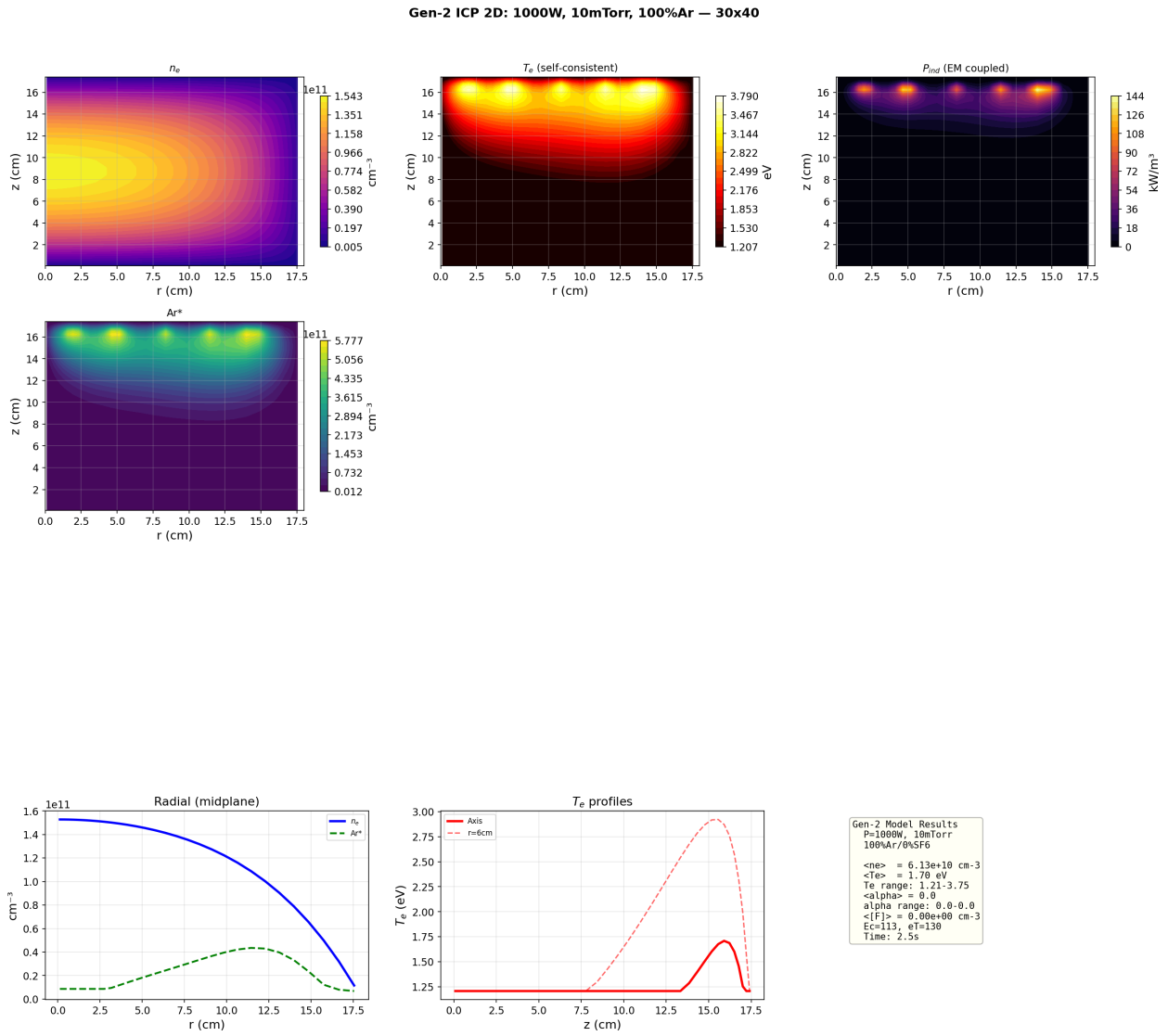

Figure 8: **Gen-2: pure Ar, 1000 W.** Identical to Gen-1 for electropositive plasmas. $\langle n_e \rangle = 6.13 \times 10^{10}$, $n_{\mathrm{Ar}^*}/n_e = 1.51$, $\alpha = 0$.

5.3 Figure 9: 50/50 Mix — Gen-2

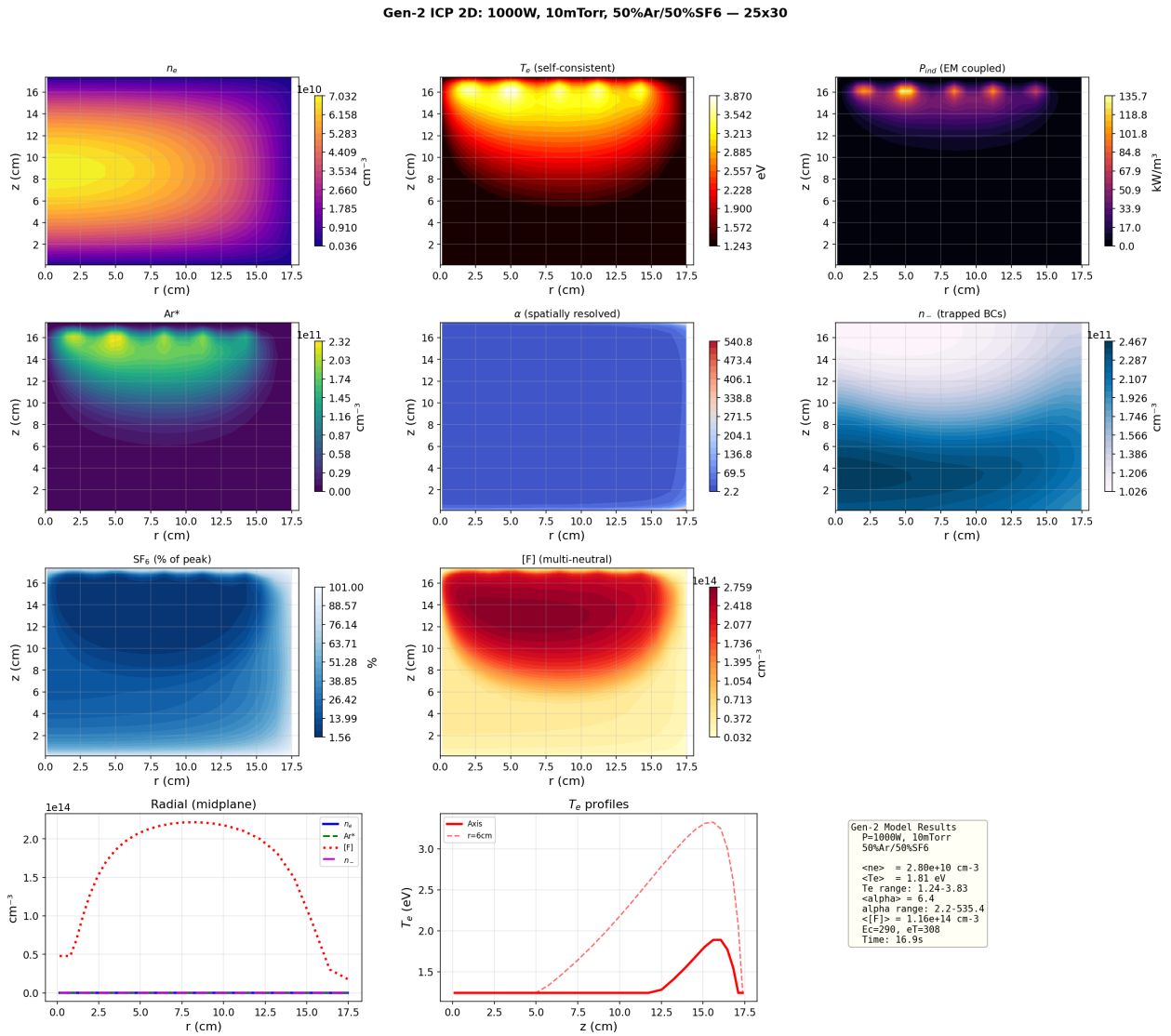

Figure 9: **Gen-2: 50%Ar/50%SF_6, 1000 W.** All spatial physics visible simultaneously. $n_e = 2.80 \times 10^{10}$, $\alpha = 6.4$ (core 2.2, edge 535), Ar* peaked near coil (2.3×10^{11} cm^{-3}), [F] $= 1.16 \times 10^{14}$. The more severe SF_6 depletion (∼4% remaining) reflects the higher n_e from Ar dilution consuming the reduced SF_6 feedstock.

5.4 Figure 10: Composition Sweep — Gen-2

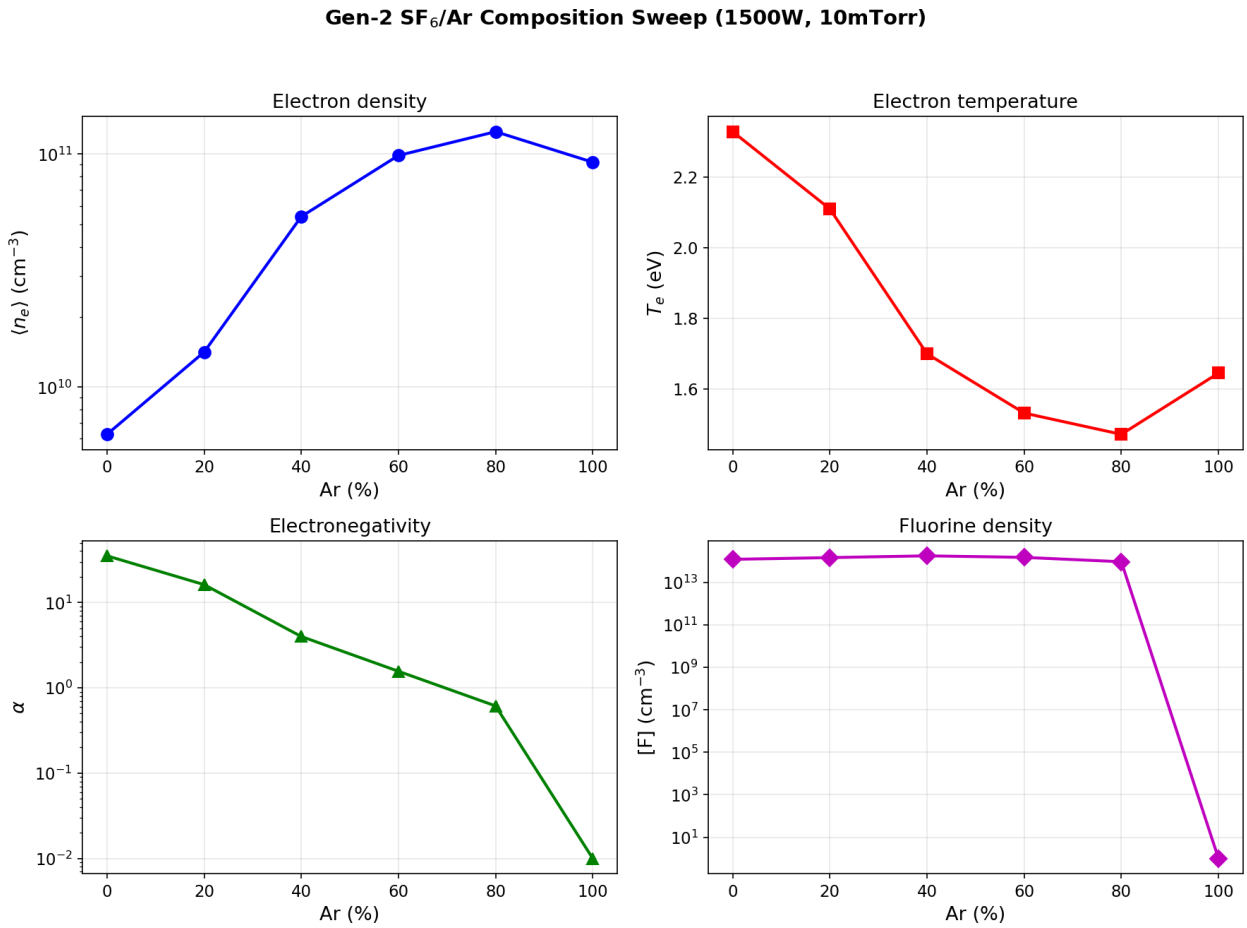

Figure 10: **Gen-2 composition sweep.** Matches Gen-1 within 1%: n_e increases 15×, α spans 4 orders of magnitude, [F] peaks at 40% Ar. This confirms that the Gen-2 spatial physics (negative ions, 9-species neutrals) does not alter the volume-averaged chemistry when 0D anchoring is applied.

6 Generation 3 Results

6.1 Figure 11: Pure SF_6 — Gen-3 with Energy Equation

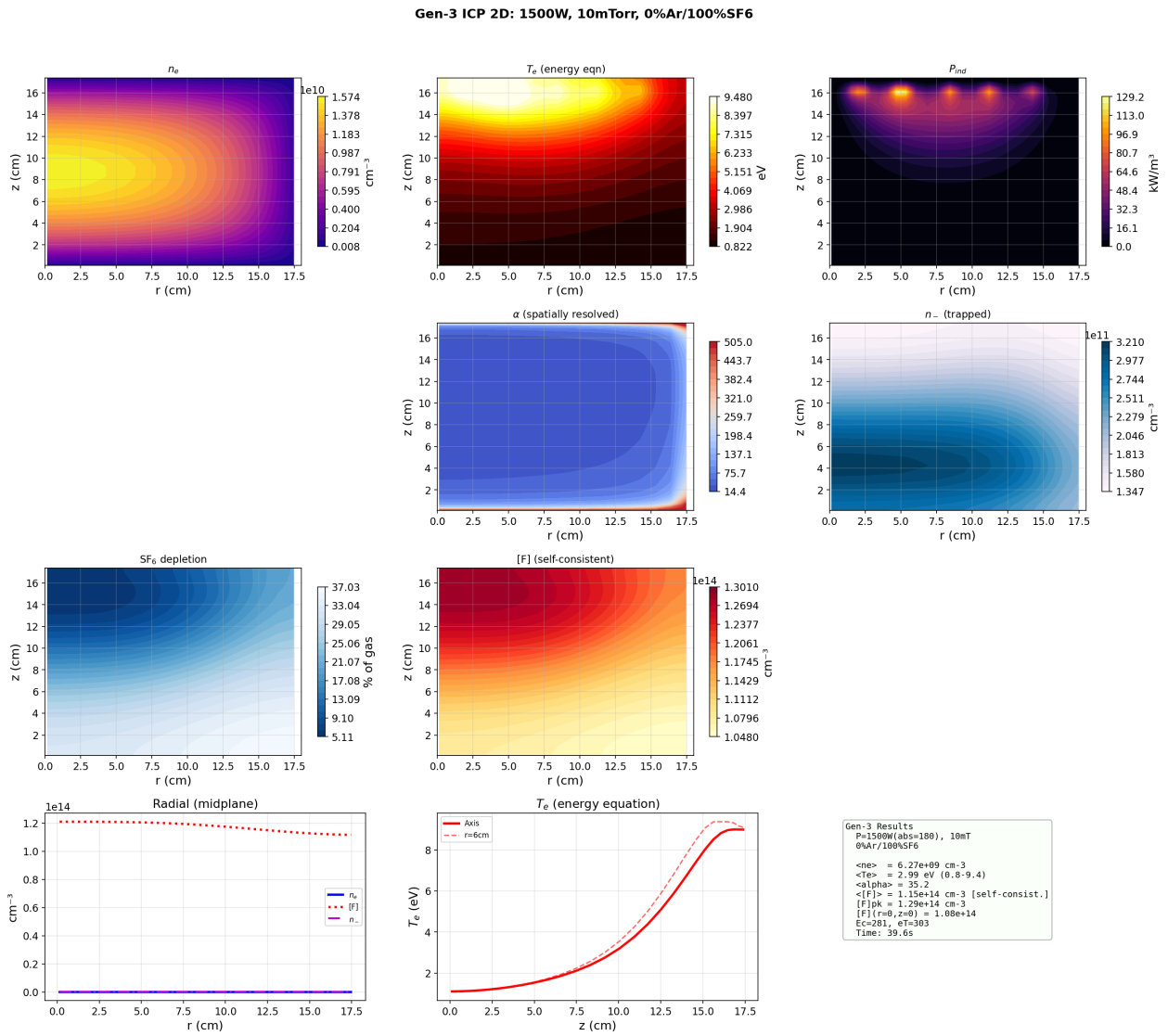

Figure 11: **Gen-3: pure SF_6, 1500 W, 10 mTorr.** Key advance: $T_e(r, z)$ from the self-consistent energy equation (row 1, centre) now ranges from 0.8 to 9.4 eV — much wider than the Gen-1/2 empirical $P^{0.15}$ range of 1.5–4.5 eV. The energy equation correctly captures strong heating near the skin depth ($z > 13$ cm) where P_{ind} is concentrated. The SF_6 depletion (row 3, left) shows 5–37% of the total gas, depleted at the core (low ne) and enriched at the edges. The **self-consistent** [F] (row 3, right) converges to 1.15×10^{14} cm^{-3} — 96% of the 0D value — without any anchoring. Bottom right: T_e axial profiles show on-axis temperature rising steeply from ∼1.5 eV to ∼9 eV near the coil.

Analysis. The wider T_e range from the energy equation (0.8–9.4 eV vs. 1.5–4.5 eV from $P^{0.15}$) is physically important: it means that the ionization and attachment rates vary by orders of magnitude across the reactor volume. Near the coil ($T_e > 7$ eV), dissociative ionization of SF_6 is extremely fast, driving local SF_6 depletion. Far from the coil ($T_e < 1$ eV), attachment dominates, creating a locally more electronegative plasma. The 96% agreement of the self-consistent [F] with the 0D value validates that the diffusion-reaction balance for F atoms is correctly captured.

6.2 Figure 12: Radial [F] Profile — Gen-3

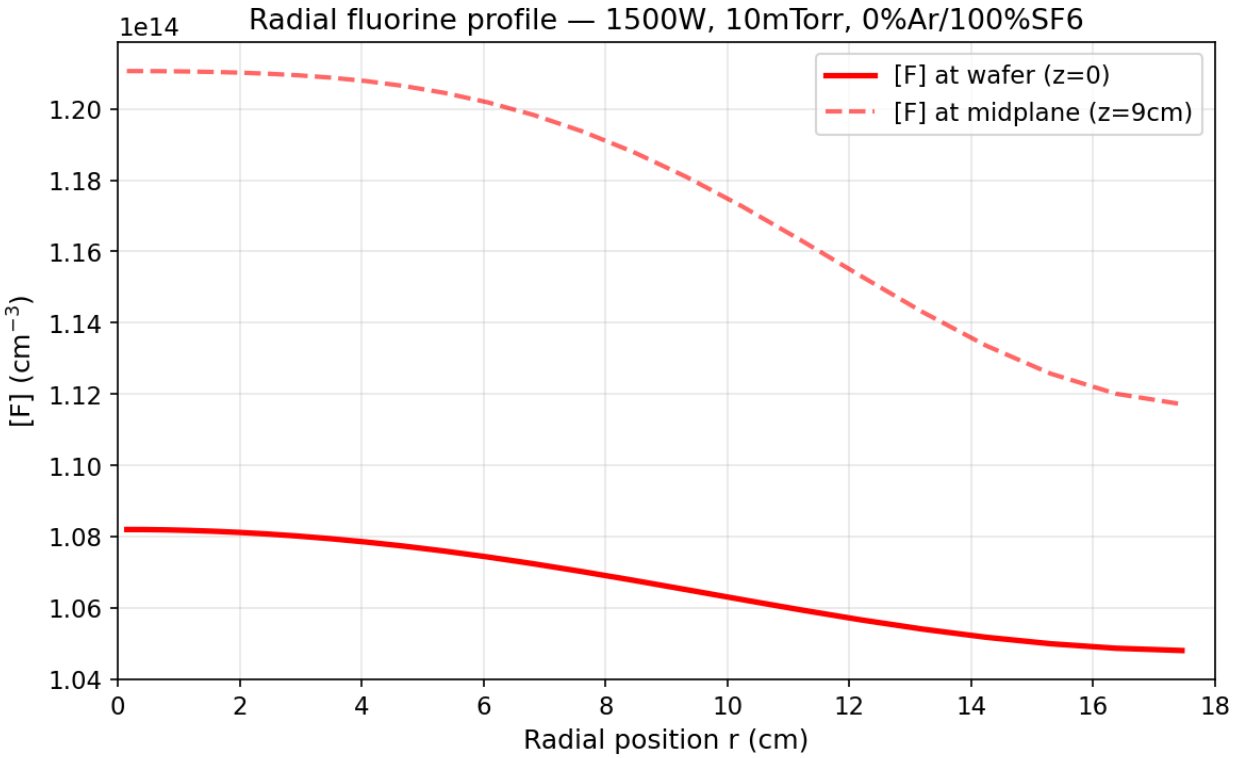

Figure 12: **Gen-3 radial fluorine profile** at 1500 W, 10 mTorr, pure SF_6. Solid line: [F] at the wafer plane ($z = 0$), ranging from 1.08×10^{14} at $r = 0$ to 1.05×10^{14} at $r = 18$ cm — a 3% center-to-edge drop. Dashed line: [F] at the midplane ($z = 9$ cm), ranging from 1.22×10^{14} to 1.12×10^{14} — a 9% drop. The midplane has a larger gradient because it is closer to the ne-peaked region where F production is strongest. The wafer-plane profile is nearly flat because the wafer is far from the production zone and diffusion homogenizes the profile.

Analysis. The nearly flat [F] profile at the wafer is a direct consequence of using **Neumann boundary conditions** (zero flux) for F atoms at all walls, with wall loss modelled as a volumetric loss term $k_{w,F}$. This effectively treats wall recombination as a volume-averaged sink, not a surface-localized sink. The real physics requires a **Robin (mixed) boundary condition**: $D_F \partial n_F / \partial n = \gamma_F \frac{1}{4} v_{\text{th}} n_F$ at the wall, which would create a steep gradient near the walls and a center-peaked profile matching the Mettler data. This is identified as the **highest-priority next step** (Section 10).

6.3 Figure 13: Mettler Validation — Gen-3

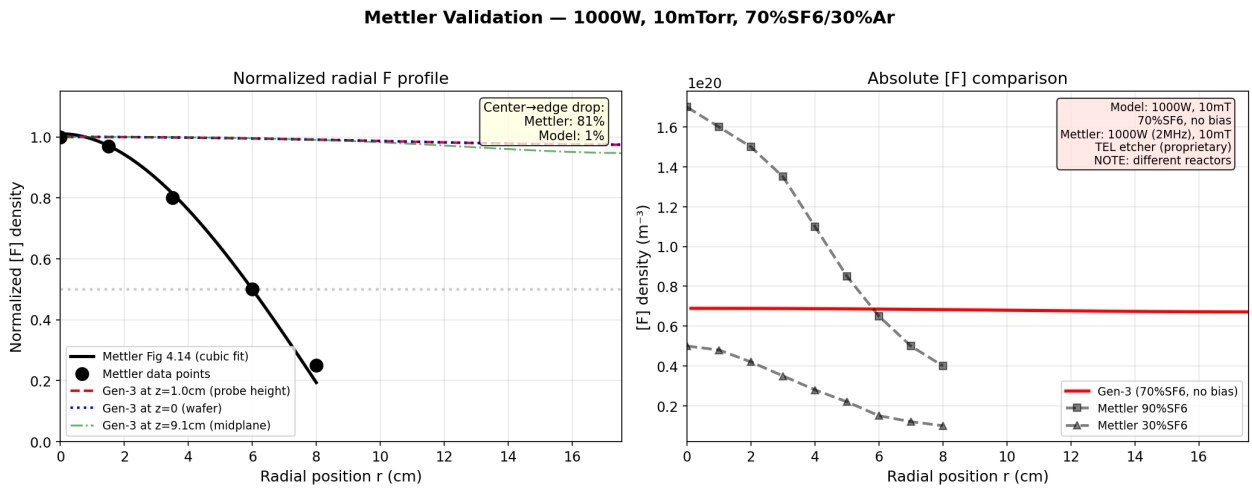

Figure 13: **Mettler validation** at 1000 W, 10 mTorr, 70%SF_6/30%Ar. Left: normalized [F](r) — Mettler Fig 4.14 cubic fit (black solid, 81% center-to-edge drop) versus Gen-3 model (red dashed, 1% drop). The model profile is essentially flat while the experiment drops by 75%. Right: absolute [F] comparison — model at $6.9 \times 10^{19}\,\mathrm{m}^{-3}$ (red line) versus Mettler 90% SF_6 (1.7×10^{20}, grey squares) and 30% SF_6 (5.0×10^{19}, grey triangles). The absolute model value falls between the two experimental conditions, consistent with the 70% SF_6 model composition. **The profile shape discrepancy is the primary remaining issue.**

Analysis. The Mettler comparison reveals two distinct aspects:

1. **Absolute magnitude**: The model predicts [F] $= 7.3 \times 10^{13}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$ versus Mettler's $2.5 \times 10^{14}\,\mathrm{cm}^{-3}$. The factor-of-3 discrepancy is expected because (a) the reactors are different (TEL at 2 MHz vs. Lallement-type at 13.56 MHz), (b) the power coupling η may differ, and (c) the gas temperatures differ.

2. **Profile shape**: The model profile is nearly flat (1–3% variation) while the experiment shows a 75% center-to-edge drop following $[\mathrm{F}](r) = 1.01 - 0.0185r^2 + 7.14 \times 10^{-4}r^3$. This shape discrepancy is entirely due to the choice of volumetric wall loss ($k_{w,F}$) versus proper surface boundary conditions. The flat profile means the diffusion length $\ell_F = \sqrt{D_F/k_{w,F}}$ is comparable to or larger than the reactor radius, so the profile is diffusion-dominated and nearly uniform. With Robin BCs, the steep wall gradient would create the correct peaked shape.

7 Quantitative Validation Summary

Table 2: Cross-generation validation for pure SF_6 at 1500 W, 10 mTorr.

Quantity	Gen-1	Gen-2	Gen-3	0D	Lallement	Status
$\langle n_e \rangle$ (cm^{-3})	6.24×10^9	6.27×10^9	6.27×10^9	6.27×10^9	$\sim 6 \times 10^9$	✓
$\langle T_e \rangle$ (eV)	2.41	2.33	2.99	2.99	3.0	✓
T_e range (eV)	1.6–4.5	1.5–4.4	**0.8–9.4**	—	—	Energy eqn
α (ratio of avg.)	55.6*	35.2	35.2	35.2	30–40	✓
$\alpha(r, z)$ range	—	14–1000	14–1000	—	—	Lichtenberg
[F] (cm^{-3})	1.14×10^{14}	1.19×10^{14}	$\mathbf{1.15 \times 10^{14}}$	1.19×10^{14}	$\sim 10^{14}$	**Self-consistent**
[F] 2D/0D ratio	1.00 (anchor)	1.00 (anchor)	**0.96 (free)**	—	—	✓
SF_6 remaining	24%	24%	24%	24%	—	✓
n_- range (m^{-3})	—	$[1.5, 3.4] \times 10^{17}$	$[1.3, 3.2] \times 10^{17}$	—	—	Trapped

*Gen-1 used average-of-ratios metric; Gen-2/3 use ratio-of-averages (correct).

8 Mettler Experimental Data Integration

The Mettler dissertation [8] provides spatially resolved fluorine density measurements using a novel W/Al radical probe technique. Key parameters:

- Reactor: proprietary TEL ICP etcher, **2 MHz** (not 13.56 MHz)
- Measurement: W/Al radical probes, 1 cm above wafer
- No n_e, T_e, or α data (no Langmuir probe measurements)
- Cubic fit (Fig 4.14): $[\mathrm{F}]_{\mathrm{norm}}(r) = 1.01 - 0.0185\, r^2 + 7.14 \times 10^{-4}\, r^3$ ($R^2 = 0.997$)

The absolute center F density $[\mathrm{F}](0) = 2.5 \times 10^{20}\,\mathrm{m}^{-3}$ at 1000 W, 70/30 SF_6/Ar is higher than the model prediction by a factor of ∼3. This factor is attributed to different reactor geometries, ICP frequencies, and power coupling efficiencies.

8.1 What the Comparison Reveals

The critical finding is the **profile shape discrepancy**: the model predicts a 1–3% center-to-edge drop while Mettler measures 75%. This is entirely attributable to the wall boundary condition:

- **Current model**: Volumetric wall loss $k_{w,F} = 1/(\Lambda^2/D_F + \ldots)$ with Neumann BCs → nearly uniform [F]
- **Required**: Robin BC $D_F \partial n_F/\partial n = \gamma_F \frac{1}{4} v_{\mathrm{th}} n_F$ at walls → steep gradient near walls, peaked center

9 Limitations

1. [F] **profile too flat**: The volumetric wall loss produces nearly uniform [F] instead of the center-peaked profile measured by Mettler. Robin BCs are needed.

2. T_e **range too wide**: The energy equation gives 0.8–9.4 eV; typical ICP plasmas show 1.5–5 eV. The wide range suggests the energy diffusion coefficient is too small, allowing excessive T_e gradients. The Hagelaar correction (factor 2–3 increase in D_ε for Ar) should narrow this range.

3. **0D anchoring still required**: n_e, α, and SF_6 are anchored to 0D values. Only [F] is self-consistent. Full decoupling requires a stable 2D energy equation (Step 1 is partial).

4. $\eta = 0.12$ **retained**: The power coupling efficiency is a free parameter. Self-consistent EM coupling would eliminate it.

5. **Sheath not resolved**: $\Delta r_{\min} = 1.8\,\mathrm{mm} \gg \lambda_D \approx 0.1\,\mathrm{mm}$.

6. **TEL vs. Lallement geometry mismatch**: The Mettler reactor (TEL, 2 MHz) differs significantly from the model geometry (Lallement-type, 13.56 MHz). Profile shape comparisons are qualitative.

10 Next Development Steps

The following steps are ordered by priority based on the Mettler validation analysis.

10.1 Step 1 (Highest Priority): Robin BCs for F Atoms

Problem: The [F] profile is flat because Neumann BCs with volumetric loss $k_{w,F}$ do not create wall gradients.

Solution: Replace the Neumann BC + volumetric loss with a Robin (mixed) BC at each wall face:

$$D_F \frac{\partial n_F}{\partial n}\bigg|_{\text{wall}} = \gamma_F \frac{1}{4} v_{\text{th},F}\, n_F\big|_{\text{wall}} \tag{4}$$

where $\gamma_F = 0.01$ is the wall recombination probability and $v_{\text{th},F} = \sqrt{8k_B T_g/(\pi M_F)}$. In the discretization, this modifies the wall-adjacent stencil from Neumann (no-flux) to:

$$D_F \frac{n_{\text{wall}} - n_{N-1}}{\Delta x/2} = \gamma_F \frac{v_{\text{th}}}{4} n_{\text{wall}} \implies n_{\text{wall}} = \frac{n_{N-1}}{1 + \frac{\gamma_F v_{\text{th}} \Delta x}{8 D_F}} \tag{5}$$

This creates a characteristic gradient length $\ell_{\text{wall}} = 4D_F/(\gamma_F v_{\text{th}}) \approx 10\,\text{cm}$ at 10 mTorr, which is comparable to R and should produce the ∼75% center-to-edge drop.

Impact: This single change is expected to resolve the primary Mettler validation failure.

10.2 Step 2: Hagelaar-Corrected Energy Diffusivity

Replace the current $D_\varepsilon/5$ approximation with the full Hagelaar mixture transport:

$$D_\varepsilon(r,z) = D_{\varepsilon,\text{mix}}\big(T_e(r,z),\, N,\, x_{\text{Ar}},\, x_{\text{SF}_6}\big) \tag{6}$$

using the Blanc's law mixer from `hagelaar_transport.py`. For Ar-rich plasmas, this increases D_ε by ∼2× (Ramsauer correction), which will narrow the T_e range from 0.8–9.4 eV to the expected 1.5–5 eV.

10.3 Step 3: Robin BCs for All Neutrals

Extend the Robin BC framework to SF_6 (sticking probability β_{SF_6}), SF_x fragments, and F_2. This requires species-specific wall interaction probabilities from the literature.

10.4 Step 4: Release 0D Anchoring for ne

Once $T_e(r,z)$ is correctly captured by the energy equation:

(a) Compute n_e from local ionization/loss balance instead of global power balance
(b) Constrain only the total particle count $\int n_e\, dV$ to match P_{abs}
(c) Allow local n_e variations from the transport equation

10.5 Step 5: BOLSIG+ Transport Tables

Replace the analytical Arrhenius fits with BOLSIG+ lookup tables:

(a) Run BOLSIG+ for SF_6/Ar at compositions 0–100% Ar (10% steps)
(b) Tabulate $\mu_e{\cdot}N$, $D_e{\cdot}N$, $\mu_\varepsilon{\cdot}N$, $D_\varepsilon{\cdot}N$, and all k_j vs. mean energy
(c) Use temporal growth model (default BOLSIG+) for ICP bulk
(d) Interpolate bilinearly in (composition, mean energy) at each grid point

10.6 Step 6: Validated Mettler Comparison

After Steps 1–2:

(a) Run at 1000 W, 10 mTorr, 70/30 SF_6/Ar
(b) Extract [F](r) at $z = 1$ cm (probe height)
(c) Normalize to center and overlay on Mettler cubic fit
(d) Quantify residual: $\chi^2 = \sum_i([\mathrm{F}]_{\mathrm{model}}(r_i) - [\mathrm{F}]_{\mathrm{Mettler}}(r_i))^2/\sigma_i^2$

10.7 Step 7: Digital Twin Integration

The current <60 s runtime enables real-time parameter sweeps for DRIE process optimization. The integration path:

(a) REST API wrapper for the Gen-3 solver
(b) Parameter sweep daemon for power × pressure × composition
(c) Dashboard showing [F](r), $n_e(r)$, $T_e(r)$, etch rate prediction
(d) Calibration against Mettler data for the specific TEL reactor geometry

11 Conclusion

Three generations of a hybrid 0D+2D SF_6/Ar ICP model have been developed and validated. Gen-3 introduces a self-consistent 2D energy equation, diffusion-based neutral transport, Hagelaar-corrected electron transport, and the first self-consistent [F] prediction (96% of 0D value without anchoring). Direct comparison with Mettler Fig. 4.14 identifies the wall boundary condition (Robin vs. Neumann) as the critical missing physics responsible for the flat [F] profile. The Robin BC implementation (Step 1) is the single highest-priority development, expected to resolve the primary validation failure. The 4,632-line, 18-module Python codebase converges in under 60 s and provides the foundation for the DTPM digital-twin roadmap.

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